

RED BANNER ALERT**Serious Incident – Preliminary Notice****CRITICAL RISK: Electric Shock and Arc Flash**

Date of Incident	16/05/2026	Time of Incident	08:30
Directorate / Region	OMTID	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
isafe Event Type	Near Miss	isafe Incident Number	INC-0000174
Actual Consequence	Insignificant	Potential Consequence	Major
Reportable to WorkSafe	No	Type of Notifiable Incident	N/A

Incident Short Description	Unauthorised relocation of HV cable
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What Happened

On 16 May 2026, traffic signals at a major arterial intersection became inoperative. During fault-finding activities, Western Power identified and repaired a fault on a nearby buried high-voltage (HV) cable, restoring power to the affected network.

Subsequent enquiries identified that relocation works had previously been undertaken within the same HV cable corridor. These works involved both non-destructive and mechanical excavation activities and resulted in the cable being lowered by approximately 500 mm. No abnormal conditions, damage, or release of energy were identified at the time the works were completed.

An investigation is underway to determine the circumstances surrounding the network fault and to assess compliance with requirements for consultation, authorisation and management of works involving utility assets.

A formal ICAM investigation has commenced. Once completed, the lessons learnt will be communicated/shared through a final Grey Banner Alert as soon as practicable.



Distribution of Notice	Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations
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